

Junho Kim

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Research Fields

International Trade, Political Economy, Geopolitics

Education

Indiana University Bloomington Ph.D. in Economics, Expected May 2027	Bloomington, IN
Indiana University Bloomington M.A. in Economics, 2025	Bloomington, IN
Yonsei University B.A. in Economics, 2014	Seoul, South Korea

Working Papers

“Tariffs as Economic Statecraft: Evidence from the Hegemon-Periphery Relationship”
(Job Market Paper) *with Mostafa Beshkar*

Abstract: Tariffs have long been understood as a tool of economic statecraft, used not only to manage trade but to extract political returns from trading partners. This may be why tariff-cut commitments so often look lopsided: a hegemon may offer periphery countries deeper cuts than it receives in return, with the imbalance possibly compensated on a different margin, namely political concessions. Using the United States as the hegemon and UN General Assembly voting as our measure of political concessions, we measure economic concessions as the terms-of-trade effect of bilateral tariff cuts and exploit variation in their value over time. We find that periods of larger tariff concessions from the US are also periods of greater political concessions by periphery countries. This holds even absent new tariff policy: a tariff schedule’s economic value is continuously revalued by shifting trade patterns, and the political returns to a concession made years earlier track this revaluation.

“Trade Imbalances and Reciprocity in the WTO: A Rule-Based Adjustment Framework” *with Mostafa Beshkar*

Abstract: This paper examines the erosion of reciprocity in the global trading system and identifies persistent trade imbalances as a key driver of deviations in trade concessions from their original WTO benchmark. We develop a multi-country structural trade model that endogenizes trade imbalances and quantifies the tariff adjustments required to restore reciprocity. Our results reveal a strong relationship between bilateral trade imbalances and reciprocity-restoring tariff changes: countries associated with larger U.S. trade deficits require systematically larger tariff increases. Motivated by these findings, we propose a rule-based policy framework inspired by Keynes’s principle of symmetric adjustment that prioritizes minimally distortionary instruments. The framework introduces a hierarchical mechanism consisting of imbalance-based fee charges, followed by targeted tariff reductions by surplus countries, and tariff increases by deficit countries as a last resort. This sequencing preserves existing trade relationships while enabling gradual correction of imbalances.

Our analysis highlights the need for coordinated and adaptive policy mechanisms to maintain reciprocity in a dynamic global trading system.

Work in Progress

“Import Sourcing under Geopolitical Uncertainty: Evidence from Korea-Japan Export Dispute”

Presentations

Hoosier Economics Conference 2024

Teaching Experience

Indiana University Bloomington

Assistant Instructor

Fundamentals of Economics for Business II Spring 2025, Fall 2025

Teaching Assistant

Fundamentals of Economics II Spring 2026

Introduction to Macroeconomics Spring 2026

Fundamentals of Economics for Business II Summer 2025

Introduction to Applied Econometrics Fall 2024, Fall 2022

Fundamentals of Economics for Business I Spring 2024, Fall 2023

Statistical Analysis for Business and Economics Spring 2023

Intermediate Microeconomic Theory Fall 2022

Research Experience

Research Assistant to Prof. Mostafa Beshkar Summer 2025

Professional Experience

Bank of Korea

Economist 2020–2022

Office of Bank Examination

Junior Economist 2014–2019

Economic Statistics Department, Research Department, and Chungbuk Branch

Fellowships, Honors & Awards

Tobias Center Research Fund Grant, Indiana University Fall 2025

Susan C. Thrasher Fellowship, Indiana University Spring 2025, Fall 2025

Lloyd Orr Graduate Fellowship, Indiana University Fall 2026

Skills

Programming: MATLAB, Stata, R, Python

Languages: English (Fluent), Korean (Native)

References

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